

MSAN Audience Workflow Settings

☒ Checked

☐ Review needed

☐ N/A

☒ Checked

Audience Association(s)

- ☒ Check that each ad group has at least one intended audience association.
Other considerations:
 - ☒ Avoid combining different audience types within the same ad group. E.g.: do not mix remarketing and in-market audiences. Instead, create separate ad groups for each targeting dimension type.
 - ☐ Verify if any (or *alternative*) remarketing or similar audiences are available through the UI, Campaigns, Tools, and Audiences sections.
 - ☐ Utilize [dynamic remarketing](#), remarketing, or custom audiences for engaging with lower funnel customers with a conversion focus.
Pro tip: If your remarketing audience is not large enough, consider starting with in-market audiences and creating a similar audience of your RLSA list to avoid a low volume issue.
 - ☐ Incorporate in-market audiences and similar audiences to engage with new customers and build a remarketing audience.
 - ☐ [Feed campaigns](#) act as a Remarketing tool (without appending new images/ad copy) by applying 'TARGET & BID' setting.
- Use the '**Bid Only**' option for feed-based campaigns, and the 'Target and Bid' option for image-based campaigns.

Why? Campaigns without any audience associations and/or incorrect combination types may lead to poor performance due to untargeted spend.

Predictive Targeting

- ☐ Review [predictive targeting](#) settings for each ad group. Predictive targeting uses Microsoft's audience intelligence signals to automatically find users likely to convert based on your ad and landing page content.
- ☐ Use predictive targeting as a standalone or layered strategy. You can run campaigns with only predictive targeting (no audience lists applied). Or layer it on top of existing audiences (set them to Target & Bid) to expand your reach.
- ☐ Use with automated bidding for best performance
Predictive targeting works best when paired with automated bidding strategies like Target CPA or Max Conversions.
Monitor performance regularly
Segment by Audience > Category in the UI to view predictive targeting results. Adjust bids, ads, or landing pages accordingly.

Why? Predictive targeting helps identify and reach new, high-converting users beyond manually selected audiences – enhancing scale and efficiency.

Publisher Report

- ☐ Within the reports drop-down review [website URL report](#) and exclude low-performing domains
 - ☐ Verify that Microsoft's owned and operated websites (MSN, Outlook, Bing) are NOT excluded from performing campaigns.

Why? Optimize audiences on certain publishers to meet your ROAS/native targets.

Day-Parting

- ☐ Set up [Ad Schedule](#) based on operating hours.
 - ☐ For optimal performance and cost efficiency, we recommend a 50–80% bid decrease for all days between 11 PM and 7 AM.
 - ☐ Alternatively, set up an Ad Schedule only for desired performing hours. This way you won't spend anything outside of this window.
Pro tip: If you are not sure where to start leverage what you know from your existing search or competitor campaigns.

Why: Without an ad schedule, it is likely that overspending will occur during the late-night hours of 12 AM to 3 AM.

Bid & Budget

- ☐ Begin your campaign with a [manual cost-per-click \(CPC\)](#) bid of a minimum of \$1 EU / USD (keep in mind, just like search bid headroom is real!)
 - ☐ Use our UI's ad group level Bid Landscape tool (UI: Tools > Planning > Audience Network Planner) to ensure that your bids are competitive.
 - ☐ Utilize the Share of Voice reporting (UI: Reports > Default Reports > Performance > Share of Voice) to optimize your budgets, bids, and ads for your audience campaigns.

Why? Avoid low traffic and effectively reach your target audience.

Conversion Goals

- ☐ [Validate UET tag setup](#) across the entire site using the UET Tag Helper to ensure your tag is firing on every relevant page - especially on thank-you pages, purchase confirmations, or lead submission URLs.
- ☐ Create event-based [conversion goals](#) for key AWF actions
Recommended goals: Page visits, Form submissions, Add-to-cart, or any micro-conversions that signal interest (great for mid-funnel intent).
- ☐ Use automated bidding strategies
Pair conversion goals with Maximize Conversions, Target CPA, or Enhanced CPC to unlock performance-based delivery within AWF.

Why? UET and accurate conversion goals unlock AWF full potential, providing volume & accountability.
Potential Issue: You'll generate impressions and clicks without measurable ROI.
Frequency: Validate at launch, monitor monthly

View-Through Conversions

- ☐ [Enable View-Through Conversions](#) in your goal settings. VTCs track users who saw your ad but didn't click - then converted later. This is essential for evaluating upper-funnel impact, especially on AWF.
- ☐ Set a view-through window that fits your sales cycle
Default is 1 day, but extending to 7–14 days is recommended for lead gen or high-consideration products where decisions take longer.
- ☐ Include VTCs in reporting for a full performance picture
Enable the "All Conversions" column to ensure impression-driven impact is visible. Review VTC CPA, ROAS, and assisted conversion Influence.

Why? Don't compare Search and AWF one-to-one.
Search captures demand already in-market. AWF creates demand, bringing new users into the funnel and influencing branded search later.

Offline Conversions

- ☐ Set up [offline conversion goals](#) to capture post-click outcomes
Track phone calls, in-store visits, CRM status changes, or closed deals that happen after someone interacts with your AWF ad.
- ☐ Upload offline conversions using MSCLKID match
Import conversion name, timestamp, value, and Microsoft Click ID via Excel or API. This data fuels smarter optimization and helps surface AWF's real value.
- ☐ Upload frequently (ideal: within 48 hours of conversion)
Regular imports are crucial to inform auto-bidding and attribution. Especially for lead gen, where conversions rarely happen on the landing page.

Why?: If you're not importing offline conversions, you're not just underreporting - you're flying blind

Device Settings

- ☐ Review [device](#) reporting and adjust bids accordingly based on your desired native key performance indicators (KPIs).
 - ☐ Note: If a campaign is already running and you're seeing desired ROAS for Smartphone traffic then start with a softer -20–30% adjustment.
 - ☐ Utilize audience segmentation (Remarketing vs. Dynamic Remarketing, Location, other demographics, etc.) to better understand how different device types perform with specific audience segments and make adjustments to bids and targeting accordingly.

Why? Desktop devices typically have the highest conversion rate among device types for MSAN campaigns.

Creative for Image Ads

- ☐ To optimize the performance of your MSAN campaigns, avoid using images with text or logos. Unlike other platforms, MSAN contains text overlay and any asset with additional text/logos will not look native and perhaps "spammy" in nature for our readers.
- ☐ Use lifestyle images that show the product in use or context rather than pure product images.
- ☐ Utilize multiple headlines and descriptions ([MMA – MultiMedia Ads](#)).
- ☐ To help combat user ad fatigue set at least 5 image variations per ad.
- ☐ Use the ad preview tool to check the appearance of MSAN ads and make any necessary adjustments.

- ☐ Review the performance of your MSAN assets, such as images and text, and pause any that have low click-through rates (CTR). Replace any paused creative with new assets.

Pro tip: You can import existing creative assets from Google, Facebook and Pinterest, select high quality Shutterstock assets via our UI's asset library (no fees), or generate assets from your landing page by entering a domain name (also within our creative library).

Pro tip: If utilizing any feed solution (E.g.: Microsoft Merchant Center), assets will pull directly from your feed and no additional creative is needed. Can be activated within 1 minute if you already have an existing Shopping Feed.

Why? Your assets are the last piece of our solution set and determine if our user clicks on your ad. By following the above recommendations, you can improve the natural feed visual experience and prevent ad fatigue for users.